



Less is More: The Radiant CMS

Need to build a website or weblog? Just want a simple CMS that makes your life easier? Radiant is for you! In this article, we explore some of the unique features of Radiant by creating a simple website with the basic components: header, menu, content and the footer. Remember, Radiant can do a lot more than what is mentioned here.

Radiant is an open source Content Management System (CMS), built using Ruby on Rails. Do not try to compare it with other major CMSs, though. Radiant, by default, is not feature-rich, and the control page only consists of three components: *Pages*, *Snippets*, and *Layouts*.

So when would you choose to use Radiant? For the past few years, I've used XOOPS, Geeklog and Plone, which were way too complex for what I need—a simple CMS to manage Web pages. No complicated theme, no access control with bunches of check-boxes—just a simple CMS that can manage pages and styles, and upload some files.

Installing Radiant

Requirements

Radiant comes with its own version of Ruby on Rails, so

a decent version of Ruby, or Ruby Enterprise Edition and the database server, is enough. Radiant supports MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, SQL Server and DB2.

I personally recommend installing RubyGems for easy installation of Radiant and other Ruby-based applications. For simplicity, we use RubyGems to install Radiant, and MySQL for the database.

Installation

Installation is simple. Just run the code given below and follow the instructions:

```
# gem install rspec radiant  
$ radiant
```

Create a database for Radiant to use. Just a 'production' database is enough, unless you are